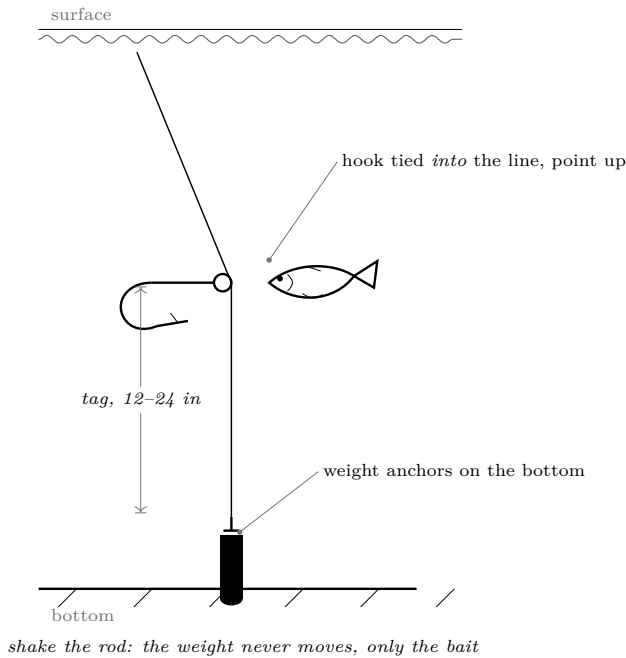


# Drop Shot

Weight on the bottom, bait suspended above it, both under your control



|                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>What it does</b>   | Everything else puts the weight above the bait. This puts it below. The weight anchors on the bottom and the bait hovers a fixed distance above it, where you can shake it in place indefinitely without moving it. |
| <b>Why it matters</b> | Fish that will not chase will still eat something that hangs in front of them. This is the rig for a tough day in deep clear water.                                                                                 |
| <b>Components</b>     | Cylinder or teardrop weight, size 1 or 1/0 drop-shot hook, small minnow-shaped plastic.                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Tag length</b>     | 12 in for bottom-hugging perch and smallmouth; 24-36 in for fish suspended off a drop.                                                                                                                              |
| <b>Line</b>           | 6-8 lb fluorocarbon on spinning tackle.                                                                                                                                                                             |
| <b>Catches</b>        | Smallmouth, walleye, perch, crappie, largemouth. On Pine Lake's east wall it is the most reliable summer rig there is.                                                                                              |

## Build it

1. Tie a **Palomar knot** with the hook, but leave a very long tag end — 2 to 3 ft.
2. Pass that tag end **back down through the hook eye**, from the top. This is the step everyone forgets, and it is what makes the hook stand out from the line at right angles with the point up.
3. Attach the **weight** to the bottom of the tag with a simple overhand loop, or crimp it into the weight's line clip so it pulls free on a snag instead of costing you the rig.
4. Nose-hook the plastic through the very tip so it hangs horizontally and free.

## Fish it

|                             |                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Drop straight down</b>   | This is primarily a vertical rig. Get over the fish and lower it.                                                                                        |
| <b>Feel the weight land</b> | Once it is down, take up slack until the line is just tight to the weight, and then stop reeling.                                                        |
| <b>Shake, do not lift</b>   | Shake the rod tip. The weight never moves; only the bait quivers. That is the entire presentation, and you can do it in one spot for a minute at a time. |
| <b>The bite</b>             | Often just added weight, or the line moving sideways. Reel down and sweep — no snap, small hook.                                                         |
| <b>Where</b>                | Pine spots <b>3</b> (the east wall) and <b>4</b> (down the sides of the bar), 25-40 ft. North spots <b>3</b> and <b>4</b> .                              |

| When to use it                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| August on Pine Lake, when the fish are deep, the sun is high and nothing is chasing. It is also the best rig in the guide for fishing a spot you can see on electronics: put it on their nose and leave it there. |

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